Assignment 1 Requirements

Assignment 1 is a Group Presentation. Each group selects one core spiritual value of Chinese civilization and uses AI tools to turn it into a concrete digital-humanities project, presented to the class as a roughly 40-minute Demo Day pitch. The presentation has three parts:

1. **Part One (~10 min), Core Spiritual Value:** explain the contemporary and global significance of your chosen core value, from the perspective of dialogue between civilizations.
2. **Part Two (~15 min), AI Product & Core Value:** use AI skills to turn this core value into a concrete AI product, and demo it live.
3. **Part Three (~15 min), Business Value & Market Prospects:** assess the commercial value of the project, showing how it could move from a classroom exercise to a potential market product.

This course covers three technical tracks: agent and workflow building, AI-assisted programming, and generative content creation. The ten groups will each carry out a hands-on project in one of these tracks. The tool(s) listed under each group below are default suggestions and can be adjusted; where two or three tools are listed, you may use just one or combine them as needed.

Dress code: treat this as a professional business pitch from start to finish. Wear business attire, and keep a consistent, professional tone throughout all three parts.

To keep the ten groups' projects clearly distinct, the following must not overlap between groups:

- The main AI tool you present and explain
- The core spiritual value you choose
- Your final product direction

Confirm your final plan with Maya before locking it in, to avoid overlapping with another group.

Presentation Structure Guideline

Part One: Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization (~10 min)

1. **Interpreting the core value:** define and explain your chosen core value precisely, examining its philosophical, ethical, social, and cultural roots, and presenting the abstract concept in clear, accessible language.
2. **Cross-civilizational comparison:** compare it with at least two other major civilizations. Do similar or comparable ideas exist there? Analyze the similarities and differences without oversimplifying or relying on stereotypes.
3. **Contemporary and global significance:** use concrete examples to show the value's relevance to contemporary life and global issues (e.g., the UN's 17 Sustainable Development Goals), setting up Part Two's discussion of how the core value becomes an AI product.

Part Two: AI Product & Core Value (~15 min)

1. **Development process:** explain which AI tool(s) you used, why, and the key steps you took to build the product.
2. **Product highlights:** explain the technical difficulty, innovation, or clever design behind the product, and demo the actual result live.
3. **Connection to the core value:** show concretely how the core value from Part One is embodied in this AI product.

Part Three: Business Value & Market Prospects (~15 min, the heart of the pitch)

1. **Target market:** who are your target users or customers? Have you talked to real potential users/customers to confirm this need actually exists? How will the product enter the market and sustain itself?
2. **Expected economic returns:** give a rough estimate of the product's commercial scale, revenue model, and main costs, and outline your plans going forward.

3. **Value proposition:** building on the previous two parts, explain why this is worth investing in and bringing to market, then take questions.

Recommended Tools for the Ten Groups

Each group can freely decide the final format of its project, for example a Q&A chatbot, a cross-civilizational dialogue simulation, an automated research report, an interactive website or mini program, a short film, visual design, a digital-human explainer video, or even a gamified experience, and can target industries such as education, healthcare, cultural tourism, or e-commerce. These are examples, not a limit; combine your chosen tool(s) and core value however fits best. The key question to answer is: why is this format the most fitting and persuasive way to convey your chosen core value?

1. Dify

Dify is an open-source platform for building knowledge-driven AI applications, centered on Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG). After you upload documents, images, or other materials, the system retrieves relevant content first and then has the AI generate an answer based on those results; the whole process can be displayed visually.

Group Members: _____

Week: _____

Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization: _____

Civilization Theme: _____

2. Coze

Coze is a no-code AI agent-building platform. It lets you give an AI different identities, knowledge bases, and language styles, creating AI characters with distinct personalities and viewpoints, and enabling structured dialogue or collaboration between multiple characters.

Group Members: _____

Week: _____

Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization: _____

Civilization Theme: _____

3. DeepSeek Harness

DeepSeek Harness is an open-source agent-building framework released by the Hangzhou-based company DeepSeek in August 2026. Its core idea is that models, tools, skills, sandboxes, and orchestration can all be freely combined and swapped. This group can configure models and tool plugins (e.g., web search, code execution) into an agent system that autonomously performs multi-step tasks, such as gathering information, analyzing it, and generating a report, and can visualize the whole build-and-execution process.

Group Members: _____

Week: _____

Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization: _____

Civilization Theme: _____

4. Lovable, Miaoda (秒哒)

Lovable is a well-known natural-language-to-web-app platform: an LLM turns natural-language descriptions into runnable front-end code. Miaoda is a no-code app-generation platform from Baidu that works on the same principle, with added localization for Chinese-language use cases and WeChat mini programs.

Group Members: _____

Week: _____

Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization: _____

Civilization Theme: _____

5. Cursor, TRAE

Cursor is one of the earliest and most prominent AI-native coding IDEs, using AI to understand natural-language instructions and generate or edit code directly. TRAE is a comparable domestic tool from ByteDance, built on domestic model ecosystems.

Group Members: _____

Week: _____

Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization: _____

Civilization Theme: _____

6. Codex, Claude Code, OpenCode

Codex (OpenAI), Claude Code (Anthropic), and OpenCode (open-source community) are three representative AI coding agents, reflecting scale-driven, safety-first, and open-access approaches respectively. All three let an AI understand a task and then write and run code autonomously, carrying a project from requirements to a working program.

Group Members: _____

Week: _____

Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization: _____

Civilization Theme: _____

7. MiniMax Design

MiniMax Design is an AI-agent-driven content production platform. You describe your creative intent in natural language, and the agent handles storyboarding, asset generation, and final editing automatically.

Group Members: _____

Week: _____

Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization: _____

Civilization Theme: _____

8. GPT Image 2 + Lovart

Lovart is an AI design agent that generates logos, posters, and brand visuals on an infinite canvas with layer-level editing; its underlying image model is GPT Image 2. The two work together: GPT Image 2 handles image generation, and Lovart builds the design layer on top of it.

Group Members: _____

Week: _____

Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization: _____

Civilization Theme: _____

9. Jimeng AI (即梦 AI)

Jimeng AI is a domestic generative-video platform (part of the CapCut/Jianying ecosystem) that turns images and prompts into short videos with a coherent narrative.

Group Members: _____

Week: _____

Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization: _____

Civilization Theme: _____

10. HeyGen

HeyGen generates an AI digital-human avatar from a photo or short video, and produces a lip-synced explainer video from a text script.

Group Members: _____

Week: _____

Core Spiritual Value of Chinese Civilization: _____

Civilization Theme: _____

AI tool tips: Both generative-content tools and vibe-coding tools for AI-assisted programming make it easy to produce a shallow, one-click demo. Keep two things in mind: (1) don't just generate something once and call it done. Iterate, debug, and polish across multiple rounds until it's genuinely usable or deployable. (2) Whatever product you build, ground it in a real, sizeable market that exists today, and in your pitch explain, using that real-world context, why someone would pay for this right now, rather than giving a generic discussion of business value.

Startup Incubation Component (Written Business Plan)

After the in-class presentation, each group writes a one-page business plan for the AI project it built, as the written deliverable for the startup incubation component. You may refine it using feedback received during the pitch from instructors, classmates, or industry guests. The business plan should answer:

- What civilizational issue does this project address?
- What value does it demonstrate for AI technology, and how does it help spread Chinese culture and promote exchange between civilizations?
- Who are the target users/customers? Have you spoken with at least a few potential users/customers, and what was their feedback?
- What is the business model? What is the rough pricing range? How will you reach your first users, and how will you sustain operations and generate revenue?
- Differentiation: why would a customer choose you over similar competitors? Based on what you actually built, what unique capability do you have that competitors lack, and that your product specifically makes possible?
- Key assumptions and risks: what has to be true for this business logic to work? What do you see as the biggest uncertainty or risk?
- If you kept going, which assumption would you validate next, or what would you do next?

Regardless of how many tools you use, the business plan should present a market-ready AI + culture product, not a review or consulting service about the AI tools themselves. The final product should be a concrete result, built with your chosen tool(s), that reflects the value of cross-civilizational exchange and has a clear selling point.

The business plan doesn't need a complex or formal layout. The goal is simply for each group to explain clearly and logically what its classroom project is, who it's for, and how it would be run.

Submission Materials & Business Plan Template

Each group must submit: (1) the presentation slides; (2) the written business plan. Grading weighs the live presentation and Q&A most heavily; the written plan is mainly supporting material. Write the business plan in English, within one page, roughly 350 to 450 words. Submit the business plan within two weeks after your presentation.

Grading Criteria

1. **Depth of cross-civilizational analysis (Part One):** 20%
2. **Learning and application of AI tools (Part Two):** 20%

3. **Quality and effectiveness of the output:** 20%
4. **Presentation of business value & Q&A, incl. written business plan:** 20%
5. **In-class delivery and presentation skills (assessed briefly):** 20%

Note: all tools listed above are default suggestions. If you think a different AI tool would suit your project better, raise it with Maya before finalizing your project and discuss adjustments together.